

Introduction

There is a story behind everything. It came from my childhood. I remembered at that time, I did not really know what I must do in the future. People keep asking me, in fact, I think I can be an inventor so that I can control things in a good way. For some reason, it would be cool. The reason I thought that because I read a quote from Lao Tzu, which is stated that The Tao of Everything existed before heaven and earth. And it is true, because in a nature way, it is still a foundation for human evolution, not just physically but also in psychology. If you go back 300 years ago, the things we grant today suddenly become out of border, which is important for future of humanity. Be able to fly, be able to see long distances, be able to connect to wireless networks, and share information in almost every place on Earth. So basically, these are the form of Tao as we supposed. It advances the knowledge of the world, advancing the scope of understanding universe and may lead to ourselves as a high consciousness species. Technology, in its deepest essence, is the manifestation of the Tao in the material world. It is not only a tool for humanity to conquer nature, but also a means to guide humankind. And the civilization is about human resources and the meaning of those resources, which is different than almost species. It shared merits, chances and risks. And the way of Tao is waiting for a person to see the picture in a deep way. In this century, we have many things which make sorrow, worrying about the future of ourselves besides the future of AI. And that is a reason why extraordinary objectives will be existed in the right time, an answer and most important questions in our century. I'm walking a tightrope while finalizing this whitepaper, and if you truly believe in it, welcome to the Adaptive Intelligence Circle, and I'll guide you through each section of this whitepaper to help you better understand everything about it, from vision to implementation, from a single room to epic and compelling millennial narratives.

Table of Contents

Part I: Introduction & Vision (Chapters 1–4)

1. Executive Summary

— A concise, powerful summary of the mission and Third Path Absolute.

2. The Intelligence Crisis

— An analysis of current AI problems (scaling, commercial acceleration, military AI).

3. The Meaning Crisis

— The crisis of meaning exists in the post-scarcity era.

4. Third Path Absolute

— A clear explanation of why an independent path is needed, not aligning with any faction

Part II: Core Principles (Chapters 5-8)

1. Core Principles

— Zero-Donation Absolute, Ethical-from-Kernel, Founder-Led Driven, Openness with Responsibility.

2. The Evolution and Limitation of Ethical Intelligence

— Ethics must originate from the kernel, not the application layer.

3. Human Meaning Network – Creating Meaning

— A vision of the infrastructure layer that helps humans maintain meaning.

4. Civilizational Protocol

— AIC/ECP is not just technology, but a protocol for civilization.

Part III: Overall Architecture (Chapters 9 – 13)

1. System Architecture Overview (High-Level)

— The 5-layer model, without going into code detail.

2. Ethical Kernel Layer

— Concept and importance (do not disclose implementation details).

3. Distributed Infrastructure Layer

— EdgeOS, DePin, Orchestration (conceptual description).

4. Application & Domain Layers

— Application domains (Education, Aerospace, Governance...).

5. Recovery & Resilience System

— Mechanisms for system recovery in case of attack or failure.

Part IV: Governance and Layer (Chapters 14-21) – Important for Risk Reduction

1. Governance Model

— Founder-Led + Technical Steering Committee + Succession Plan.

2. Legal and Compliance Framework

— Open Collective, Open MDW License and GPL-3.0, Fork Monitor and Reputation System.

3. Zero donation policy and Financial Independence

— Explanation of philosophy and operating mechanism.

4. Risk Management and Adversarial Preparedness

— How the project prepares for malicious forks, political attacks and FUD.

5. Fiscal Host

6. Leverage Architecture

7. Political risk management

8. Anti-Artificial Engagement Policy

Part V: Current Status and Development (Chapters 22-24)

1. Current Status and Achievements (update June 2026).

2. Roadmap 2026-2036.

3. Call for contributors.

PART I

1. Executive Summary

The Adaptive Intelligence Circle (AIC) is not a typical AI project. It is a protocol for restructuring civilization, built on the understanding that technology cannot be separated from human ethics, meaning, and responsibility.

In a context where AI is becoming a tool for power competition among superpowers and large corporations, AIC chooses the third path – Third Path Absolute: an absolutely independent system, not dependent on Big Tech or China. We build Ethical-from-Kernel – ethics is not an application layer but an immutable core of the system. At the same time, we create a Human Meaning Network to prepare for the post-scarcity era, where technology will not only solve needs but also help people rediscover the meaning of existence.

AIC was born from a challenging personal journey, but quickly grew into an ecosystem of over 40 repositories, with core principles of zero-donation, thorough transparency, and decentralized governance. We don't chase speed or scale, but are steadfast in building a protocol that is resilient, adaptable, and respects human nature in a chaotic era. The fact that the Adaptive Intelligence Circle (AIC) started in Vietnam, has inadvertently transformed it into a manifesto from Global South. AIC challenges the long-held notion that only major technology centers (Silicon Valley, Beijing, or London) can initiate and lead a civilized protocol. The emergence of AIC demonstrates that the idea of restructuring can originate anywhere, provided there is a clear vision, perseverance, and a solid system of principles. It is an affirmation that the future of civilization does not necessarily have to be shaped by old centers of power, but can be built from lands seeking a third path.

This whitepaper presents our vision, core architecture, Leverage Architecture strategy, and roadmap from TestNet to MainNet. AIC doesn't seek to replace the present, but strives to forge a new path – where technology becomes the foundation for an ethical, meaningful, and truly human civilization.

We invite like-minded individuals and communities to join this journey. Not to follow a trend, but to jointly create a future where technology and humanity can coexist.

2. The Intelligence Crisis

The AI Crisis...

Today, the concept of AI has become an indispensable part of human life and technological infrastructure, but most people still don't truly understand its nature. Because the nature of AI is very complex and has a long history, from around the early 20th century to the present day in 2026, major corporations have divided AI into different ideologies, each representing a part of the truth – that AI can become the infrastructure of civilization for the entire society, not just applications embedded in IDEs or responding to user needs. Following the COVID-19 pandemic, which led to increased demand for online interaction between users and businesses, and even governments, the sudden emergence of AI models like ChatGPT in the following years is an inevitable trend, and it can be asserted that the influence of Big Tech in leveraging crises to increase and consolidate its position is truly tremendous. This is based on the following solid foundations:

- Because most of them possess enormous resources and assets.
- Their growth rate is exponential.
- Influence from the crowd effect, media networks, and support from governments (especially in countries with neutral positions).

Therefore, Big Tech and international organizations currently hold the cards that can change the landscape of technology and policies regarding intellectual property, trade, etc., and the development of independent projects is also not immune to the influence of these giants. Besides the positive aspects, the expansion of large organizations also leaves behind unforeseen consequences, not only economic or political advantages. “The faster the better” — Accelerate AI development to the maximum to create enormous economic value, national/business competitive advantages, and solve major

human problems through growth. This is both the biggest opportunity and the biggest bottleneck. They believe that AI is the most transformative technology in human history. Holding back or slowing it down is dangerous (potentially causing the US/China to lose the race). Profitability and scale are the best ways to invest in long-term safety. The main arguments of this faction include:

- Economic growth: AI will create tens of trillions of dollars in value, solving poverty, curing diseases, advancing science, etc.
- Geopolitical competition: If the US lags behind, China will take the lead and shape the future of AI in its own direction.
- “Safety through Capability”: The stronger the AI, the easier it is to control (an argument contrary to the Existential Risk faction).
- Reality: “We cannot stop the race, we can only win it.”

It reminds me of my ancestors. Our ancestors left behind these heartfelt sayings for their descendants: "What comes easily also goes easily." The big players are willing to use coercive tactics and bribery to consolidate their position. A prime example is the lawsuit between Microsoft and IBM/Linux in the 1990s, where Microsoft sent a puppet company to control Unix to prevent Linux's expansion. The result is clear: Linux became a crucial platform, controlling 96% of servers worldwide. It's also worth mentioning IBM's significant contribution in proactively backing Linux for seven years (2003-2010). With IBM already holding a strong position since the 1990s and early 2000s, having Linux was like giving a tiger wing. Looking at the history of Microsoft and its allies, we can see that it still has some rather frightening limitations, such as:

- Prioritizing profit over safety: OpenAI transitioned from non-profit to for-profit, collaborations... Close ties with Microsoft are a prime example.
- High risk of misalignment: Rushing too quickly can easily lead to safety margin cutting, bias, deepfakes, and mass job losses.

- Bubble formation: Many experts believe there is currently an AI bubble similar to the dot-com bubble of 2000.
- Lack of long-term vision: Focusing too heavily on "move fast" easily overlooks existential risks and crises of human meaning.
- Narrative manipulation: Often using the phrase "Responsible AI" as marketing, while actions prioritize scale and profit.

Sam Altman is the perfect embodiment of this group. Despite dropping out of the prestigious Stanford University at age 19 and recently being considered to have limited technical thinking, he can passionately talk about "AGI will save humanity," but then immediately transform OpenAI into a for-profit company and collaborate closely with Microsoft. They aren't necessarily bad. They're just pragmatic in a capitalist way: whoever is faster wins. But all the arguments above are still just the tip of the iceberg. Understanding Big Tech thoroughly through the media isn't the most comprehensive approach, not to mention that this is also their strongest battleground, where they can manipulate the truth as they wish. One of the most subtle ways the tech society does this is by sometimes deceiving people into thinking they are in control of it. Technology itself is a product of free will; it indirectly affirms the ego or self through creativity or the exploitation of power. Because the power of technology is not just swords or guns, it is an assertion of intellectual sovereignty and legislative capacity. This further confirms that legal standing has become far more important than geographical location since the advent of the Internet at the end of the 20th century, which created a true revolution in all fields and changed how people interact and connect forever. This further emphasizes the ontological nature and role of humanity in this crisis. In my view, the intellectual crisis is one of the most important and unavoidable crises for several objective reasons. But we can take it as a lesson to create new parallel principles, contributing to transforming this crisis into an opportunity to create new evolutionary steps for human civilization. This is the fundamental basis that we must understand before discussing or debating AI, because the story is not simply about which AI is stronger or which organization is more reputable in AI. It might be built on the political or legal ideas of a particular country, such as Constitutional AI, but does that guarantee the AI's safety when it could unintentionally or intentionally harm many people while seemingly respecting that country's laws? This

is a sensitive topic, and the incident between Anthropic and the Pentagon in early 2026 illustrates this. In this case, a country's laws might benefit that country itself, but somehow conflict with the laws of neighboring countries, creating an endless war. Therefore, a fundamental change is needed, not just a superficial one. That foundation could touch the human element through a decentralized protocol that any entity can participate in and develop a core to ensure a transparent ethical network that can restructure existing infrastructure. And is it possible for a verifiable moral entity within the kernel to interact with humans continuously in real time? The answer is yes. Although developing it requires some controlled positive bias principles, and skillfully respecting national sovereignty can create a fundamental shift without conflicting with vested interests or monopolistic tendencies at any level. This is the reason for the emergence of technically liberal models, such as Linux, Apache, Firefox, Android, and other open models, which have created what I call "OSS 1.0" revolutions—somewhat reducing the monopolistic power of Big Tech and increasing its credibility with the community. But AIC is trying to revolutionize at a deeper level, specifically shifting from the "Code is Law" perspective to "Ethical is Law," meaning ethics must become the core, not just the surface. This is gradually becoming a part of human life in this era and is an inevitable development of science and technology as it expands into more diverse fields and research becomes increasingly varied.

3. The Meaning Crisis

Meaning in a Crisis...

This is one of the most abstract parts of this white paper, simply because it represents the highest goal a decentralized protocol can achieve. If a protocol fails to reach this level, it will not be able to solve existential problems; instead, it will only create new, increasingly difficult and complex problems. Why do I emphasize this? Because it's not as direct as seeing a rocket launched into the sky or a company releasing a product with a flashy, polished UI. A protocol always operates implicitly within every system instead of becoming something that can be assimilated into a commercial product. So, what role does human meaning play in this whole story? Is it simply a matter of individuals creating meaning, just as I created meaning with AIC? It can be understood from a creative perspective, when you wholeheartedly dedicate yourself to a protocol or product that you believe is truly important to humanity in the long term. This is absolutely true for AIC, which I built almost from scratch in the early stages, even turning it into a rather extreme

principle that created an independent path compared to many other projects. AIC has given me a unique direction in life and career. From the skepticism and difficulties, I have learned many lessons, especially, the challenges of AIC, as many perceive them, can be an "advantage" to help AIC achieve the highest level of transparency. This is something I am somewhat proud of, because we know that AIC can bring value that society is lacking in the fierce wave of AI.

Therefore, I can assert that the significance of the crisis being discussed here lies in the question of a time when human life is almost entirely dominated by materialism (except for some impoverished areas of the world). In this case, the existential crisis is the gradual loss of humanity, along with the question of "what is the purpose of my existence?" while still having creative goals and basic needs. This concept, in some 19th-century theories, is called "the Post-Scarcity," simply understood as the replacement of the essence and purpose of labor. Have we reached Post-Scarcity yet? Not yet. But we have begun to move towards this trend. Let's look at the past few years, even into late 2025 and early 2026, as the world is entering a period of significant upheaval: global economic growth is slowing, geopolitical tensions are increasing, while technology and artificial intelligence continue to expand their influence on social life. Global economic growth is projected by international organizations to fluctuate around 2.8–3.2%, lower than expected, reflecting a slowdown in supply chains, persistent inflation, and a lack of full recovery in investment confidence. Meanwhile, emerging economies in Southeast Asia, particularly Vietnam, are showing stronger resilience, becoming a bright spot in the global picture. Simultaneously, geopolitical tensions continue to escalate: the US and China remain locked in a fierce confrontation in technology and trade, Russia and Ukraine have yet to find a way out of their protracted conflict, and the Middle East is witnessing new instability causing significant fluctuations in oil prices. Many countries are also beginning to promote green policies and transition to renewable energy, but progress remains uneven, creating a large gap between regions. In this context, technology – especially artificial intelligence – continues to expand its influence, not only as a computing tool but also as a meaningful infrastructure where people seek to connect knowledge and human values. Based on this trend, the Human Meaning Network emerges as a crisis-response concept: it measures development not by GDP or military strength, but by the ability to maintain meaning, humanity, and social cohesion in the technological age. As AI increasingly integrates into life, from education and healthcare to social governance, the Human Meaning Network becomes a global effort to redefine development, helping people avoid being swept away by the flow of data and

conflict, and instead find a common network for dialogue about ethics, identity, and meaning in life. To do this, I try to come up with those ideas:

Original thinking -> ideas -> core technology -> infrastructure and space exploration -> restructuring -> applications -> creating meaning.

Why must this happen? This is because the Adaptive Intelligence Circle and Human Meaning Network were not created to win in the conventional sense – to dominate market share or increase competitive advantage. They must coexist with the Founder and reach out to the community. AIC/HMN must exist long enough for people to feel that developing ethical models is as essential as water, and its philosophy goes against current popular thinking about the concept of restructuring. Essentially, the meaning of human existence, when placed on a philosophical foundation, can be asserted to rely on the principle of cause and effect to distinguish between any immoral action and one that constructs a moral meaning. The concept of morality is general and encompasses all knowledge and the unconscious, but it is not absolute. It serves as a guiding principle for knowledge and the unconscious, rather than completely replacing or controlling them. Therefore, the restructuring process must ensure ethical principles while remaining flexible in a constantly changing context. What does this mean? It means that, under any circumstances, actions (understood here as the interaction between source code and developers) must be based on core principles without breaking them. These principles will adapt to most situations, be documented, and verified in real time. The biggest test is the post-scarcity scenario, as mentioned. When scarcity ceases, there is no longer the motivation for competition and no longer progress in the old sense. From there, immoral states will flourish at all different levels, and systems like religion will gradually lose their effectiveness because they all rely on scarcity to operate. This picture is truly terrifying, isn't it? More terrifying than any political ideology because the line between right and wrong has become blurred. It reminds me of Anton Chigurh in "No Country for Old Men"—a character who acts without any motivation stemming from scarcity of money or material possessions, as if everything is meaningless and empty. It's important to note that post-scarcity, as predicted by many experts and thinkers, occurs at a high rate; it's a tragedy no one can avoid—like Judgment Day in Terminator, except no one dies from bombs or land grabbing. It slowly corrupts people from within. Ultimately, this is the reason I've developed AIC and HMN over the past period: not to become a billionaire like someone else, but simply to ask insightful questions and offer practical solutions.

4. Third Path Absolute

The Third Path is consistent....

The Third Path is not a new concept; it first appeared in political theories in the late 1990s. It was developed as a clever and logical option for weaker nations seeking stability without dependence on superpowers like Russia, the United States, or China. The idea of the Third Way was initially considered impractical according to market principles, as weaker nations would have to rely on larger nations for supply chain development and even security protection from attacks. This always has two sides: without cooperation, the nation could face pressure from larger nations, increasing the risk of large-scale war. Conversely, while cooperation, to some extent, might bring economic and security benefits, it could lead to control over supply chains, knowledge, legislation, and free trade. This is a harsh reality, and its root cause dates back thousands of years, stemming from one of the most fundamental human attributes: tribalism. Tribalism is not only a primitive social phenomenon, but also the fundamental logic governing international relations and modern economics. When large nations form “power tribes,” they establish the rules of the game, supply chains, and knowledge norms. Weaker nations, if they want to survive, are forced to choose sides or accept being drawn into their control. This is a global manifestation of tribal instinct. In the field of technology, especially AI, Big Tech operates like modern tribes. They control computing infrastructure, data, and research standards. Independent projects like AIC face pressure from these tribes: they are simultaneously recognized, scrutinized, and sometimes constrained to prevent them from escaping their orbit. This clearly reflects that tribalism exists not only in international politics but is also deeply ingrained in the global knowledge and technology structure.

Essentially, the third path is the most challenging project I've ever undertaken compared to any previous one. Why? Because it requires the necessary sacrifices to create an unassailable advantage; in this case, AIC has had to confront major institutions since January 2026 and seek exploratory cooperation in various ways. This shows that the third path in AI is a unique and strategic direction, as it creates a pincer movement between the familiar two superpowers, the US and China. I must emphasize that this is a courageous decision for many objective reasons, but it is necessary to build trust from those who want to build the human infrastructure. AIC's perspective on infrastructure is very different from most other classic projects. The third path means ethical principles at its core, rejecting all investment from large capitalist enterprises, and not owning or selling any services for personal gain. To elaborate a bit, AIC is a protocol where the community can distribute but still contributes to the shared vision of AIC. Technically

speaking, AIC has redefined the concept of the "third way" to a higher level. With AIC, the third way goes beyond policy of common OSS; it has become a vital mechanism of the Human Meaning Network. We recognize that people are a crucial infrastructure alongside software and hardware, as traditional computer science theory suggests, and developing people alongside technology in a responsible and humane way strengthens the practicality of the third way. In any cyberattack, the most important factor is sometimes not the software or servers, but the people. Therefore, AIC has inherited from its predecessors but also created a different vision from those who came before it. It is the culmination of Richard Stallmann's philosophy of software freedom, kernel-centric approaches like Linus Torvalds, Vitalik Buterin's decentralized networks, Elon Musk's ecosystem expansion and Nguyen Duc Tri's entire contemplative observation, all aimed at restructuring civilizational infrastructure ethically and creating meaning. This is an ambitious goal, a long-term mission that I and the future community are striving towards.

Part II

1. Core Principles

First, I will begin with the policy of not accepting any investments and not selling any services for personal gain. I mentioned this in the previous section; you can review it in the Third-Path absolute section where not accepting any investment can create a "monopoly of trust." However, some people will disagree with this view, as most believe that another source of resources can increase speed and sustained motivation. I truly understand this because, historically and in terms of human survival instincts, we always need tools, or in other words, reward mechanisms, to affirm ourselves. This has also happened in the tech world over the past 50 years, with many classic projects like Facebook, WhatsApp, SpaceX, Google, Oracle,... and even open-source platforms like Linux or Signal receiving millions of dollars in investment within their first five years and becoming platforms that impact many different fields. Economically, this can create millions of jobs and contribute billions of dollars to the economy. Technically, most of these projects focus on one or two fixed problems; for example, Linux often focuses on the system kernel, and Facebook optimizes the user experience. They rarely address the ontological consequences after becoming an integral part of people's lives. This can be

called a production gap, a bottleneck in projects that have received investment. Let's look deeper into the issue because when a project reaches the scale to change the landscape, every investment has a long-term plan behind it. This means that money isn't the only important factor for a large-scale project; it needs trust, and in this case, the trust of the investors themselves. Western capitalists understand this and have used the media to gain a more favorable position for their projects in the eyes of investors, thereby further solidifying their political power.

You can see a very logical sequence of events here: from idea -> tools -> political power. These develop as an inevitable rule and become part of the operating mechanism of most projects, from small to large scale. But in this world, there have also been projects that don't accept donations and still manage to create unimaginable impacts. For example, Wikipedia or even AIC, despite still being in its early stages, have attracted considerable attention from major institutions. To be honest, the fact that AIC received such significant attention without any donations was a turning point that I myself hadn't anticipated in such a short time. For the traditional open-source community, an AIC project can have both positive and negative impacts. On the positive side, AIC possesses unique characteristics compared to most other projects, as its influence can spread ethically with its austere technological principles. On the negative side, it mainly stems from its novelty compared to most other open-source projects and has been questioned regarding its sustainability, potentially even inadvertently threatening the position of other open-source projects. It's safe to say that whether you or I are working on any form of technology project, we will inevitably face political pressure; this is inevitable, and learning to survive requires extraordinary adherence to principles. It also doesn't mean cutting off diplomatic opportunities with large organizations, as doing so would jeopardize a network of credibility and diminish global influence. This is difficult because during expansion, it's easy to lose sight of the fundamental principles you've painstakingly built. Therefore, AIC minimized this risk by establishing strict policies from the outset – something many other large projects only implement after a significant number of developers have been acquired.

Secondly, I want to mention the concept of Ethical From Kernel. I mentioned this concept in the previous section when I referred to ethics as a general and all-encompassing, but not absolute, quality. It's a guiding layer for knowledge and the unconscious, not a complete replacement or controller. In my case, ethics becomes the core of the entire system; that is, the AIC system must be general and all-encompassing, covering the

entire ecosystem and guiding all directions and experiences. Ethical From Kernel is not simply a new idea in technology, but a combination of technical freedom and humanism. When creating Ethical From Kernel, the difficulty lies not only in the technical aspects but also in the humanistic flexibility within a volatile environment. The most profound idea of Ethical From Kernel is that ethical intelligence arises from uncertainty, not from absolute quantification like most mathematical models in history or quantum physics. To elaborate a bit further, we can't eliminate the problem, but we can identify its root cause and transform it into energy for further improvement and learning. This is a cyclical and necessary process in an era of ever-changing technology where the boundaries between humans and machines are blurring. I see this very closely in everyday life, for example, the misuse of tokens in AI to complete projects, from coding to executing commands in IDEs or browsers. This directly impacts and destroys originality and creativity in the minds of innovators. Strangely enough, we have countless engineers, but lack someone with the spirit to confront problems that are not only technical but also philosophical. Ethical From Kernel demands that the community and founders confront these issues transparently and honestly through intelligently disclosing source code to ensure the highest level of development and continuity. Ethical From Kernel brings a completely different perspective compared to Anthropic or other AI security research, which focuses solely on guardrails while neglecting transparency and infrastructure prioritized for profit. For me, this is a revolutionary evolution that is gradually being implemented in practice through TestNet. It directly transforms OSS into a meaningful infrastructure, rather than just a framework controlled by corporations to enhance their monopoly and market share. From AIC's perspective, corporations are not the biggest problem because they are a consequence of governance thinking shaped by the market—the market sustains not only businesses but also workers and social welfare. Therefore, Ethical From Kernel is not about fighting corporations, but about redefining governance and how the market sustains society. Ultimately, this is the state that Ethical From Kernel can achieve and become the foundation for the post-scarcity era.

The third thing I want to mention is Founder-Led Driven. My name is Nguyen Duc Tri, born on August 18, 2004, and I live and work in Hanoi, Vietnam. I am still a final-year student like many of my peers. I also have my own aspirations, and those aspirations can represent the voice of those who share a vision for a brighter future. This whole story stems from a simple question: "Can we make AI more flexible in real time?" This question arose from my experience using OpenAI's products; I realized that in interacting with AI, it reflects the limitations of human logic and ego. AI, in the conventional sense, is trained on billions of reference data points and responds to the needs, from emotions to thoughts, of the user. This leads to the feeling that corporations may have been subtly

and intentionally manipulating things without users realizing it. This is one of the most sophisticated diseases of this century, and if not prevented early, education could be negatively impacted. I thought it was that simple, but gradually, what started as an idea has become a globally valuable ecosystem, not just creating an AI with a high parameter count (because I don't have the resources to do that), but transforming AI into a protocol capable of impacting at the infrastructure level. As a founder, I will always want to stick with this idea long-term because of its mission; I can't just sit back and consume everything like I did when I was a high school student. Throughout my career, I applied for a software engineer and AI tutor position at xAI (now merged with SpaceX) in July 2025 and was invited to apply for an AI data training position at Invisible Technologies in April 2026. In the same year, I am currently participating in FlyRank AI as an AI Fluency intern. Honestly, these have been incredibly interesting and valuable experiences for my youth. It's proof that I've had the honor of interacting with large organizations while pursuing my personal mission. Of course, I have to learn to balance things and not be too tempted by attractive offers because it can have long-term consequences if I'm not careful with my schedule. And I still dedicate my full time to AIC, because I built it almost from scratch. The founder Led-Driven is not simply a manager, but also acts as a system designer, technology philosopher, political scientist, and programmer. The founder Led-Driven demands a huge long-term responsibility, even though no one has seen clear results in the short term. Like many other founders, you have to go through a period of solitude before you can truly connect with someone. This period of solitude is actually the most valuable time in a founder's life, even if it's a little difficult. Starting a business is like chewing glass, as Musk said, and it's absolutely true. Persistent mental training is the most valuable asset, sometimes more valuable than money. Therefore, with AIC's vision, being slower than the norm isn't a big deal; in return, you can find the right path and sustainable principles. Does that make me happy? Yes. But you have to sacrifice peace of mind when creating value with lasting consequences. It's not simply about external conflicts, but also internal ones. Actually, doing something big doesn't make you great, it makes you more human. It means that the vulnerable parts of you can be revealed more honestly. Sometimes it's really bad, but it also helps you stay humble and keep moving forward. All of this has laid a solid foundation for me to continue working every day. Technically, a Led-Driven Founder has to manage the entire technical aspect, from source code and system architecture to legal frameworks and this white paper, and face real-world technical limitations. These are experiences I've accumulated in my early years of work. They are important, albeit bitter, lessons that have become the raw material for truly touching people's hearts.

The fourth point I want to address is openness, but with responsibility. This is also one of the most important highlights of this project and aligns perfectly with an ethical protocol. Many might be surprised that an ethical protocol can allow all programmers and researchers to quietly distribute, share, and learn from it. Open source is not just a new technological phenomenon, but a major technological revolution of the 20th century. Typically, the vast majority of users are using applications or libraries without realizing that the software itself is running on an underlying platform that can change its workflow quickly and conveniently. It's even more unbelievable that open source can be valued at billions of dollars; its value lies not in direct financial gain but in its strategic vision and legacy. Therefore, with a platform that emphasizes ethics, an open value can be elevated to responsible and meaningful freedom. AIC not only brings technical freedom but also forces all users to recognize the immense role of ethics from the root, that it can be maintained by the community. Open Source is not only valuable in peacetime but also in times of turmoil, its role continues to inspire programmers worldwide. I believe that ethics is a value belonging to the community and can adapt to different cultures. The most difficult aspect of an open model is that each jurisdiction has its own complexities, so the challenge lies in harmonizing all these complex issues into a platform that can endure and ensure ethical boundaries. Previously, classic models like Linux, Kubernetes, and Signal all emphasized transparency and security but were still limited within a framework. AIC inherits all of this transparency and security but on a much broader scale. Fortunately, we have designed a mechanism to monitor forks and record who has contributed significantly to AIC. This is long-term in nature; essentially, if AIC can become the standard for secure AI and meaningful networks, then all participants in the network will be recorded in AIC history and this will be essential certification for participation in other AI-related work. Furthermore, the Fork Monitor ensures that any violations and disrespect for AIC's policies from the outset will be recorded and serve as evidence that AIC is extremely serious about building a transparent network. Fork Monitor is what sets us apart from previous projects; of course, the mechanism must ensure certain legal compliance to prevent exploitation or infringement of privacy, which we have been preparing for. Additionally, open source in the future could be the solution to most complex problems, rather than focusing on just a few large corporations as we see today. Especially in AI technology, open source AI is one of the essential and worthwhile options to consider. We should also pay attention to another aspect of open source: security. For example, OpenClaw has been criticized for security issues for some time, although we cannot deny the successes this platform has brought to the new direction of AI agents. AIC will also focus on security in the future as the community embraces this idea, as it relates to the longevity of ethical protocols. Therefore, ethics from the root, as mentioned in the previous section, will be further clarified in the following section.

2. The Evolution and Limitations of Ethical Intelligence

In this section, I would like to emphasize the limitations and evolutionary nature of ethical intelligence. The advantages I have mentioned regarding an ethical protocol lie in minimizing the risks associated with other closed ethical models. The purpose of ethical intelligence is not to compete, but to contribute to and build a new management mindset. However, over time, any technology, including ethical protocols, has certain limitations. They will continuously evolve over time, but the question is whether evolution will break the core limitations or principles of the present moment? This question currently lacks a clear answer, but we can define the limitations of ethical protocols at the present time. Limitations here are understood as resources and disruptions in the social structure. As mentioned, intelligence originates from uncertainty; however, it still requires an internal order within that disruption. This order is established by AIC, and the evolution of a protocol is a conscious evolution. Historically, there have been instances of changes to the original structure. The Linux Kernel was initially designed with a spirit of complete freedom and decentralization. But after becoming the world's core infrastructure, it was gradually influenced by large corporations (Intel, Google, Microsoft) participating in the Linux Foundation. Some later technical decisions leaned more towards corporate interests than the original spirit. Satoshi created Bitcoin with the spirit of "Code is Law" and against the centralized financial system. But later, the emergence of large mining pools, ETFs, and listed companies brought Bitcoin closer to the traditional financial system it once aimed to replace. Or even the Internet, which was born with a spirit of decentralization, openness, and freedom. Today, it is dominated by a few big players (Google, Meta, Cloud providers) and a global oversight system. AICs are still very new and are beginning to gain global recognition due to the attention of major institutions; however, there is still much work to be done. The most worrying aspect is the risk of AIC self-destructing despite having strong defenses to protect from external forces. Anyone familiar with the Hard Forks that happened to Vitalik Buterin in 2016 will understand the consequences of a decentralized network fragmented by internal conflict. Therefore, AIC is extremely cautious about this issue, implementing a series of strict policies with an open model. This is significant because it is predicted that within the next few years, Ethical systems will become a hot topic, no less significant than other centralized models. This was already hinted at at the end of 2025, and AIC was established in April of the same year. In 2026, AIC will enter its second and most crucial phase, as this will determine the transition of AIC from an in-depth study to Global South's first ethical protocol. Gradually, this will lead to the restructuring of the infrastructure – the ambitious legacy I planned since April 2025. I can jokingly compare

it to SpaceX's IPO this year, when Elon decided to expand human life into space. One focuses inward in the most original way, the other outward at the speed of light. They don't exclude each other but complement each other, despite their vast differences in thinking. The future of AIC remains uncertain, as any large-scale project needs time and trials to prove itself. Despite its limitations, AIC still aims for a platform that fosters human values and systems.

3. Human Meaning Network – Creating a meaning

Next, I will analyze the Human Meaning Network. First, I can say that the Human Meaning Network is not Facebook or other typical social networks. The Human Meaning Network is a completely new concept that I developed at the end of January 2026, when I realized that the development of AI was too rapid while human awareness had not kept pace, leading to a dependence or illusion of controlling AI through policies or external mechanisms. For 99% of people inside and outside the industry, the Human Meaning Network is something unfamiliar, although some recognize its strategic value. This is something I have emphasized in most of my previous articles before this whitepaper, and its significance has become a principle that needs more thorough discussion. Secondly, I also realized that most people do not understand the motivation behind creating AI. The biggest question, in fact, lies in human resources – and AIC, as a protocol for restructuring civilization, encompasses almost every aspect of this dynamic. For me, this is one of the most fundamental and profound issues of the AI age, not just technology. The world as we know it today is divided into three categories: profit and power, national security, and scientific curiosity. All three lack depth in terms of human resources; humans are primarily input resources rather than the center of meaning. In the broader picture of human civilization, where technological advancements are constantly reshaping the boundaries of what is possible, we stand on the brink of an era that promises to eliminate scarcity itself. This post-scarcity world, driven by exponential advances in artificial intelligence, automation, renewable energy, and quantum computing, is not merely a utopian dream but an imminent reality, projected to unfold within the next two to three decades. Essentially, the HMN is a self-reflective and interconnected network, built to address the Camusian absurdity that arises when survival is guaranteed, yet existence becomes an empty echo.

To understand the depth of the HMN, one must first grasp the philosophical foundations that gave birth to it. In a world rapidly hurtling toward a post-scarcity era, the traditional dynamics of human endeavor—competition due to scarcity, the pursuit of wealth, and the struggle for resources—will vanish. Albert Camus, in "The Myth of Sisyphus," described absurdity as the clash between humanity's yearning for meaning and the universe's indifferent silence. Technically, we are building the infrastructure for humans to find and preserve meaning in a post-scarcity era, where AI can replace most intellectual and manual labor. The Human Meaning Network is not intended to pressure Big Tech but to redefine governance—from profit-driven governance to governance of meaning, responsibility, and ethically bounded freedom. The deepest essence of this action is that no matter how powerful technology becomes, it needs a new, deeper layer of governance rooted in human nature. This is the true evolutionary step from AI serving humanity to AI helping humans better understand who they are and how they should live. The Human Meaning Network is a crucial evolution of the Adaptive Intelligence Circle, expanding from fundamental ethical thought into a network that enhances the role of humanity. I can say that developing the Human Meaning Network is incredibly difficult for many reasons, but I believe its independence will be key to a safe open-source and AI revolution. Technology can help solve many problems in life, but it needs to go hand in hand with ethical development from both sides, and that inspires hundreds, even thousands, of projects pursuing this path. In the post-scarcity era, meaning is not just a survival goal, but the next evolutionary step for human society in the coming century.

4. Civilizational Protocol

In this section, I will discuss the concept of a Civilizational Protocol. What constitutes a civilized protocol? Is a civilized protocol defined by its coverage across a large number of users? Yes, but that's not entirely comprehensive. A truly civilized protocol must possess the following elements: quantity, ethics and humanity, long-term integration capabilities, and source code transparency. These are the principles for starting a civilized protocol. If any of these elements are missing, it's difficult to consider it a civilized protocol. Historically, we witnessed the emergence of the Internet in the late 1990s; the protocol covered all of humanity but wasn't necessarily civilized because it lacked an ethical infrastructure and was gradually manipulated by Big Tech in the following years. Creative Commons is a license that doesn't cover all of humanity, but it is civilized because it sets an ethical standard for knowledge sharing. To put it another way, Blockchain has always had a wide reach and is the origin of Bitcoin, ETFs, and Web3, but only when governance is added does it come close to becoming a civilized protocol. Therefore, understanding

a civilized protocol is a continuous, long-term effort because when implemented across many different fields, it will face pressure from policies and competition from more resource-intensive models. The approach to a protocol usually originates from a small group with a dedicated spirit and faith in a better future for humanity. In the case of AIC, it originated from an individual outside of Silicon Valley or prestigious academic institutions. This is truly rare, although the outcome of the journey remains uncertain. Technically, considering the tradition of computer science, it was surrounded by many early state-of-the-art physical infrastructures, such as the US government's ARPANET in the mid-20th century. AIC broke this rule with a new mindset: building a multi-layered protocol with ethical legislation from the core to the network of human meaning. AIC did not have any state-of-the-art physical infrastructure; instead, the entire source code was decentralized and open, and users could distribute and contribute based on policy and recognition through a reputation mechanism. This was not just a new technology, but also a philosophical statement: protocols do not necessarily come from the most powerful centers; they can come from persistence and a strong belief in a third path. What could be the challenge for a civilized protocol? It's the complexity of management. A protocol originating from a single source, when scaled up into an autonomous network, can experience disruptions, system failures, and the collapse of numerous neighboring systems. Therefore, AIC doesn't sell any services but focuses on maintaining sustainability and scalability. I have statistics showing that approximately 93% of the global population owns mobile phones, with smartphone users accounting for about 60% to 70% of the world's population (equivalent to 4.8 to 5.7 billion people). Furthermore, about 74% of the global population currently uses the internet. Therefore, each individual or device acts as a server, exponentially spreading ethical values; this is the most accurate idea of an underground infrastructure that functions as a capillary network of human society. And another important question is whether AIC will replace the internet? The answer is no. Imagine the internet as a blood vessel containing only information, while AIC is a neural network that coordinates and protects from the source. This becomes even more interesting considering that both hold strategic elements that could change the landscape at various levels in the future. The internet could be broadcast into space, like Starlink is today, and AIC also views space as a new source of civilized and ethical life. That's the vision, but there are many challenges ahead. Perhaps in 20 years, the concept of protocols will be elevated to a new level, and that level can only be established now, through the passion and ambition of youth.

Part III

1. System Architecture Overview (High-Level), Evolutionary by Design and The Kardashev Scale.

This is one of the most important sections in the entire white paper. It encompasses the overall architecture of the ecosystem and is an expression of the Ethical from Kernel, Third-path Absolute, and Human Meaning Network philosophies. As mentioned, AIC is a multi-layered protocol, and all layers are interconnected under the ethical kernel principle. In comparison to the Internet, the Internet's architecture is a layered system based on the TCP/IP model with four main layers: Link, Internet, Transport, and Application. It is designed to ensure global connectivity, flexible scalability, and decentralized operation. And now, I give you the layer description of AIC:

Layer 1 – Ethical Kernel

+ This is the heart and "hard constitution" of the entire system.

+ It deeply embeds the principles of: Third-Path Absolute, Zero-Donation, and Meaning Preservation.

+ All layers above must adhere to it and cannot be bypassed.

Layer 2 – Adaptive OS

+ Adaptive operating system, resource management, scheduling, isolation.

+ Operates under the continuous supervision of the Ethical Kernel.

Layer 3 – Infrastructure Layer

+ EdgeOS, DePin, Aerospace/Starlink equivalent, Quantum, Recovery.

Layer 4 – Application Layer

+Practical applications: Education, Health, Governance, Energy, Creative, AIForDriver...

Layer 5 – Human Meaning Network (HMN)

+The highest layer, focusing on human meaning, mental recovery, and preparation for post-scarcity.

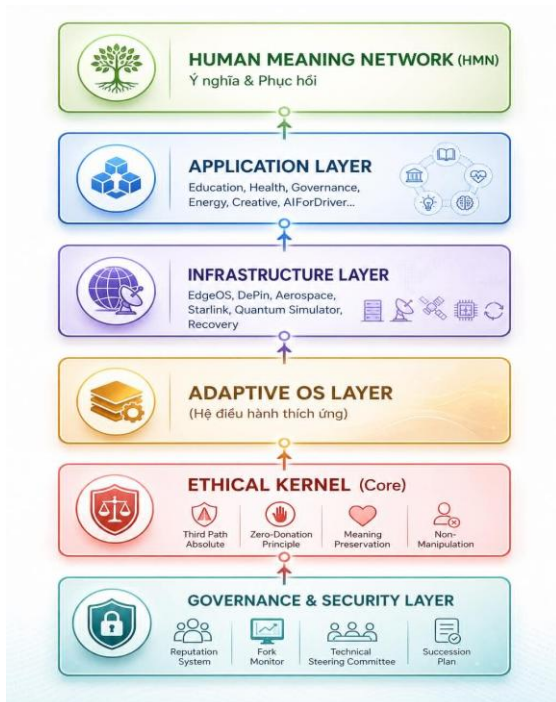
Horizontal Layer – Governance & Security

+Covers the entire system: Reputation System, Fork Monitor, Succession Plan, Technical Steering Committee.

The architecture of AIC reveals itself as a layered system, intelligible to both researchers and programmers. It is composed of five vertical layers and one horizontal layer. The vertical layers embody the evolutionary hierarchy of the Adaptive Intelligence Circle, culminating in the Human Meaning Network at the apex. The horizontal layer spans across them, serving as the connective tissue that integrates and harmonizes the whole. Compared to Ethereum's architecture, Ethereum's current architecture is based on a two-layer model: Execution Client (transaction processing, EVM) and Consensus Client (Proof-of-Stake consensus). This is a major change after Ethereum transitioned from Proof-of-Work to Proof-of-Stake, allowing the network to maintain both computation and consensus.

Generally speaking, AIC's architecture inherits some of Ethereum's progressive spirit, such as distributed networks, DAO governance, and scalability and community maintenance. However, AIC also has fundamental technical differences; instead of focusing solely on consensus mechanisms or human connectivity, AIC strives to optimize processes based on sustainability. AIC is optimized because it doesn't rely on tokens or smart contracts; it has five sustainability layers and one horizontal layer. These layers not only process data but also integrate a humanistic layer, extending the process beyond economic considerations to encompass social implications. The AIC process is

designed to reduce friction; instead of simply processing data for those who pay, AIC optimizes through knowledge and collaboration. The Internet possesses a layered and continuously optimized process for fast, globally scalable data transmission, but lacks a humanistic layer. While the Internet ensures packets can be transmitted from server to client, AIC ensures packet security and prevents distortion by centralized power. Therefore, AIC optimizes not only technically but also socially: reducing the risk of manipulation and deviation from established norms. Besides its optimization capabilities, AIC possesses practical reasoning but is still in the transition phase between Phase 1 and Phase 2, the most challenging stage for a Founder-Driven. One limitation of AIC's architecture is its lack of performance optimization. For example, ethical principles from the ground up can increase the necessary safety, accuracy, and humanistic aspects, but conversely, the operational capacity on a large system is significant and increases decision-making latency. This is logical because AIC has a bias towards humanistic principles that can be open-coded for machine learning. Performance is a crucial issue for most current AI models, so AIC's approach is not to completely replace AI models but simply to build a safety layer under the infrastructure and restructure governance towards ethical safety. AI models like ChatGPT, Grok, Cursor, and Claude are all ensuring extremely high performance with the support of Nvidia GPUs, allowing them to process large datasets in a short time. This could lead to a "Single Point of Failure," as 70% of internet users rely on these platforms. Processing large datasets without security could affect user perception and undermine AI's position in the development of computing infrastructure. Below is the diagram of AIC:



Architectural Philosophy: Evolutionary by Design

The architecture of Adaptive Intelligence Circle is not designed to exist in a fixed point in time, but is born with continuous evolution as its core principle. We call this Evolutionary by Design – an architectural philosophy that views change not as an exception to be overcome, but as a natural and necessary aspect of a truly civilized system.

Instead of building a rigid system that later requires major overhauls (like many current technology platforms), AIC is designed from the ground up with the ability to evolve smoothly, safely, and without disrupting its core identity. This stems from the understanding that technology and human civilization are both living entities that must constantly adapt to changing realities while maintaining their ethics and fundamental meaning.

Thanks to this design, 95% of changes and upgrades in AIC can occur incrementally and safely, without the need for large, costly, and high-risk overhauls like many traditional systems.

Why Evolutionary by Design is Necessary?

In the AI era, technology changes at a dizzying pace. Systems built statically or optimized only for the short term will quickly become cumbersome, outdated, or manipulated. AIC chooses the opposite path: building the ability to evolve from the ground up, so that the protocol not only survives but also evolves with humanity over decades while maintaining its ethical identity and independence.

Positioning in the Era of Major Protocol Reforms

In the 2020s, many major protocols are undergoing extensive overhauls. Ethereum with Lean Ethereum, Solana with Firedancer, Polkadot 2.0, and even the Linux kernel are all striving to restructure to address issues of technical debt, scalability, and future

challenges. These overhauls highlight a clear reality: most current technology systems require internal repairs after periods of rapid expansion.

Adaptive Intelligence Circle (AIC) takes a different path. Instead of belated overhauls, AIC is designed from the ground up with continuous evolution (Evolutionary Design) through a 5-tier vertical and 1-tier horizontal Governance and Security architecture. We don't pursue maximum scale or short-term profits, but focus on building a long-term, transparent, ethical, and resilient protocol from the core.

In an era where giants are "leaning" to survive, AIC positions itself as a benchmark for the third path – not just technology, but also a foundation for a responsible and meaningful civilization.

Positioning Against Semi-Decentralized Models

In the context of many large protocols shifting to semi-decentralized models – where real power is concentrated in a small group of validators, builders, or entities while maintaining a superficial decentralized layer – Adaptive Intelligence Circle asserts the path to true decentralization from the core to the application layer.

These hybrid models often prioritize short-term efficiency and profit, but are prone to covert control, failed governance, and dependence on a few large entities. In contrast, AIC designs the Ethical Kernel as an immutable foundation, combined with the horizontal Governance and Security layers, to ensure not only technical decentralization but also the decentralization of power and ethical responsibility.

We believe that only when ethics are embedded from the lowest level and power is truly decentralized can a protocol serve humanity in the long term instead of being manipulated by vested interests.

Positioning in a Diverse Technological Landscape

Today, the technology ecosystem is diverging into several models: fully centralized (Big Tech AI), semi-decentralized (multiple L1 blockchains), federal/consortium (enterprise projects), and sovereign (Sovereign AI). Each model has its own advantages but all carry inherent constraints: control of power, dependence on group interests, or serving geopolitical goals.

Adaptive Intelligence Circle positions itself completely differently. Not belonging to any of these forms, AIC pursues Third Path Absolute – a truly decentralized model, ethical at its core, and aimed at restructuring civilization. With its 5-tier vertical and horizontal Governance and Security architecture, we not only distribute technology but also distribute ethical responsibility and power, enabling continuous evolution without being constrained by any central entity.

In the context of a world searching for a third path, the AIC does not directly compete with existing models, but rather offers an independent, transparent, and humane alternative for the Global South and neutral nations.

AIC and the Kardashev Scale – A Different Path to Civilizational Advancement

While humanity is moving towards Kardashev Type II by increasing energy exploitation (like SpaceX's projects to put data centers into orbit), the Adaptive Intelligence Circle (AIC) chooses a different path – one that doesn't race for physical energy, but focuses on restructuring the consciousness and ethics of civilization.

The AIC's five-tiered vertical architecture, combined with the horizontal Governance and Security layer, doesn't aim to maximize computing or energy scale, but rather to embed ethics from the core (Ethical Kernel) and build a Human Meaning Network – a sustainable layer of meaning for humanity in the post-scarcity era.

We believe that a truly progressive civilization needs not only abundant energy, but also a system to guide that energy to serve moral growth and the meaning of existence. AIC

represents a counterintuitive but necessary direction: not Type II in terms of energy, but a crucial step towards a Type III civilization in terms of consciousness and responsibility.

Conclusion

This is the fundamental difference between building a tool and building a civilization. Overall, I believe that the AIC architecture developed over the past year will continue to be inherited in the future, leading to many new AIC models that still ensure core security and computational performance.

2. Ethical Layer

This is the foundation, containing immutable principles (the third path, no funding, preservation of meaning). The Ethical Kernel is the rigid constitution of the entire system, ensuring that all actions and decisions adhere to ethical principles at the lowest level. In the architectural diagram I've shown you, the Ethical Kernel is the first layer above the governance layer and it connects directly to the Adaptive OS. In this section, I will discuss the Adaptive OS layer in more detail as part of the Ethical Kernel. The Adaptive OS is an adaptive operating system responsible for resource management, isolation, and scheduling, and operates entirely under the supervision of the Ethical Kernel. The Adaptive OS has a very different layout compared to Windows/Linux, although it inherits some advantages of these two open operating systems. Adaptive OS ensures that the system acts as a real-time brain, connecting with Adaptive AI to form an AI operating system capable of continuously adapting to changing contexts. A Human In-the-Loop layer exists within this AI operating system to incorporate human roles in the final decision-making process. This is a direct correlation to the Human Meaning Network, which can become a network with an adaptive brain like Adaptive OS, ensuring stable operation as it expands. The Ethical Kernel is not only applied to Adaptive OS but also strengthens distributed infrastructure such as EdgeOS, DePin, Aerospace, Quantum simulation, and recovery mechanisms. DePin and AeroSpace are targets for network expansion to politically neutral countries and into outer space, with the hope of creating a secure internet operating in orbit. Of course, realizing this is still a long way off and involves many risks, as these are areas of contention among major global powers. However, distributed infrastructure ultimately acts as an intermediary between the

Ethical Kernel and the Human Meaning Network, transforming AIC into a decentralized protocol while still ensuring core principles are upheld. Building distributed infrastructure is not simple, and I will explain this in more detail in the next section.

3. Distributed infrastructure Layer

This is one of the most important components and acts as an intermediary layer between the core and the distributed network. The infrastructure plays a role in transferring code from source code to distributed protocols. Unlike traditional systems that focus purely on scale and performance, the AIC infrastructure is designed with the principle of Ethical by Default – every component must adhere to the Ethical Kernel from initialization. This layer includes five main components:

3.1 EdgeOS (Edge Operating System)

EdgeOS is a lightweight operating system optimized for edge devices such as phones, routers, IoT gateways, and personal computers. It allows AIC to operate efficiently even in environments with limited or no internet connectivity. EdgeOS not only manages local resources but also enforces local ethical rules before synchronizing with the larger network, ensuring privacy and data autonomy for users.

3.2 DePin (Decentralized Physical Infrastructure Network)

DePin is a decentralized physical infrastructure layer that leverages surplus resources from the community (bandwidth, storage, computing). Instead of building massive data centers, AIC encourages a "community-owned infrastructure" model. Every node participating in DePin must adhere to the Ethical Kernel, ensuring that physical resources are not used for manipulation, surveillance, or profit maximization that violates the Third Path principle.

3.3 Aerospace Infrastructure

This is a future-oriented component, focusing on building decentralized space infrastructure through AIC—Starlink equivalents—and interplanetary protocols. The Aerospace Layer not only provides global connectivity but also prepares for the multi-planetary era. AIC aims for an open, transparent, and ethical space model, in contrast to

the strong trend of closed vertical integration currently taking place among major players.

3.4 Quantum Simulation Layer

Quantum simulation doesn't necessarily require a real quantum computer at the outset, but rather a simulation and optimization layer based on hybrid quantum-classical algorithms. This layer allows the Ethical Kernel to simulate millions of complex ethical scenarios in a short amount of time, helping the system predict and prevent principle violations before they occur. This is a crucial step for AIC to handle the complexity of post-scarcity.

3.5 Recovery Mechanism

The Recovery Layer is a mechanism for restoring meaning and the system, ensuring that even in the event of a serious incident (malicious fork, attack, or social crisis), AIC can still recover to a state of compliance with core principles. This is not just technical recovery, but also the recovery of human meaning through the Human Meaning Network.

Therefore, the Distributed Infrastructure Layer is not just technical infrastructure, but the physical manifestation of the third path. While traditional infrastructure systems pursue two opposing extremes – the strong centralization of Big Tech and profit optimization, or complete decentralization leading to chaos and abuse – AIC chooses the third path: principled, transparent, and ethical decentralization from the core. This layer represents a deliberate disruption to the 21st-century technology model. We do not pursue the construction of giant data centers or proprietary satellite systems. Instead, AIC builds a community-owned infrastructure where every individual and organization can contribute surplus resources (bandwidth, computing, storage, space connectivity) while adhering to the Ethical Kernel. Every participating node is part of a self-regulating system, not a tool for exploitation or manipulation. In particular, the integration of Aerospace Infrastructure and Quantum Simulation Layer demonstrates AIC's long-term vision: preparing for the multi-planetary and post-scarcity era. We are not only building infrastructure for Earth, but also preparing for humanity's expansion into space—an expansion not driven by profit or military issues, but guided by ethical principles and human meaning.

However, the Distributed Infrastructure Layer also reminds us of a crucial limitation: technology, however distributed, is merely a tool. Without an Ethical Kernel and Human Meaning Network at a higher level, any distributed infrastructure risks degenerating into a more sophisticated new control tool. This is why AIC doesn't stop at "opening up" infrastructure, but demands a continuous commitment to core principles.

AIC's Distributed Infrastructure Layer is living proof of the belief that a truly advanced civilization is not one with the most powerful technology, but one that knows how to restrain and direct technology to serve human dignity and lasting meaning. In the context of humanity standing on the threshold of a post-scarcity era, where AI can replace most intellectual and manual labor, we believe that only a distributed, transparent, and ethical infrastructure at its core can help humans not only survive, but truly live meaningful lives.

This is not the end of a technical chapter, but the beginning of a new journey of civilization—where technology is no longer the master, but becomes a loyal servant of human will and conscience.

4. Application & Domain Layers

The Application and Domain Layers are where AIC's philosophy and infrastructure are realized into concrete applications that directly serve people in their daily lives. This is the layer closest to the end user, where the core value of Third Path Absolute is verified through real-world experience. Unlike traditional AI platforms, where applications are designed primarily to optimize engagement, profitability, or operational efficiency, AIC's Domain Applications must strictly adhere to the Ethical Kernel from inception. Every feature, algorithm, and interface is designed with the principle of "Ethics from core to edge."

4.1 Education Domain

The education system on AIC not only imparts knowledge but also fosters critical thinking, creativity, and a sense of responsibility. Courses are personalized but do not manipulate learning behavior. The system will reject content or methods that encourage addiction, harmful competition, or one-sided ideology. The Education Domain aims for a long-term goal: building a society that thinks independently and is capable of seeking meaning.

4.2 Healthcare Domain

AIC's healthcare applications focus on supporting holistic health (physical, mental, and meaning of existence). The system will reject business models that exploit fear or dependence on medication. Health data is strictly protected under the Meaning Preservation principle – it cannot be used to manipulate behavior or sold to third parties. The Healthcare Domain aims to heal both body and mind, especially in the context of a growing meaning crisis.

4.3 Governance Domain

This is one of the most important domains of AIC. Governance Applications allow communities, organizations, and even local governments to build transparent, accountable, and decentralized governance systems. The system will automatically alert or prevent decisions that violate Third Path Absolute, such as abuse of power, corruption, or information manipulation. The Governance Domain does not replace the state, but provides tools to improve the quality of governance from the bottom up.

4.4 Energy & Resource Management Domain

The energy and resource management application focuses on optimizing resource use in a sustainable and equitable manner. The system prioritizes energy allocation for basic human needs rather than maximizing profits. Resource allocation decisions must undergo scrutiny by the Ethical Kernel to ensure they do not violate the principles of Meaning Preservation and Zero-Donation.

4.5 Creative and Cultural Domain

AIC recognizes creativity as one of the highest expressions of human meaning. The Creative Domain supports artists, writers, and researchers in their development without being manipulated by algorithms that encourage addictive or extremist content. The system protects individual intellectual property rights while simultaneously encouraging the sharing of knowledge in an open and ethical spirit.

4.6 Consistency of Domains

Although each Domain has a distinct function, all are designed to adhere to a common Ethical Kernel. This creates system consistency: whether users interact with Education, Healthcare, or Governance, they are protected by the same core set of principles. This is the fundamental difference between AIC and current platforms—where each application often has its own individual ethical policy and is easily altered for business interests. Application & Domain Layers are not just places to provide services, but also real-world laboratories to test whether an ethical protocol from the kernel can actually improve people's quality of life.

The Application Layer is the intermediate layer between the distributed infrastructure and the human meaning network. It asserts that while AI is not an application itself, it is a protocol capable of impacting people's daily lives. By applying ethical protocols to many fundamental and essential aspects of human life, they will find meanings that expand into a Human Meaning Network. The Human Meaning Network is the final evolutionary step of application, becoming a pervasive consciousness within human awareness once AI has become the infrastructure. The Human Meaning Network is the final evolutionary step of application, becoming a pervasive consciousness within human awareness once AI has become the infrastructure. Consistency across independent applications creates a true ecosystem, with the Ethical From Kernel as the guiding principle. The application layer, supported by the distributed infrastructure, can maintain a consistent user base and ensure the recovery mechanism I will discuss below.

5. Recovery & Resilience System

In a complex, distributed system like AIC, failures are inevitable. The Recovery and Resilience System is designed not only for technical recovery, but also to protect and restore human meaning – this is one of the most important characteristics that distinguishes AIC from traditional protocols.

AIC's Recovery System does not follow the conventional backup and restore model. We believe that a truly resilient system must be able to recover without losing its essence. Therefore, a recovery mechanism must strictly adhere to the Ethical Kernel and Third Path Absolute principles. The system is built on the principle: "Recovery is a return to meaning, not just a return to a technical state."

The main components include:

5.1 Technical recovery layer

+ Ethical-from-Kernel: All recovery processes are governed by the ethical kernel (IBCS). No recovery action may bypass ethical introspection and anomaly detection.

+ Sovereignty First: Recovery must preserve user/node sovereignty and never grant temporary central control.

+ Privacy & Minimal Impact: Recovery must minimize data exposure and never collect unnecessary information.

+ Third Path Absolute: Recovery mechanisms must remain independent from any government, corporation, or external authority.

+ Zero-Donation: No financial incentives or external funding may influence recovery infrastructure.

In addition, the recovery layer works directly with the distributed infrastructure, so it can be further explained by the following three characteristics:

+ Fork Monitor & Safe Fork Mechanism: The system automatically monitors and detects malicious or core principle-violating forks. Only forks that comply with the Ethical Kernel are recognized as valid.

+ State Checkpointing: Periodically encrypted and distributed recovery points across the network ensure the system can return to the nearest state while maintaining ethical integrity.

+ Quantum-assisted Simulation: Uses quantum simulation to predict severe incident scenarios before they occur.

5.2 Meaning Recovery Layer (Human-Centric)

This is a unique layer of AIC, closely connected to the Human Meaning Network (HMN). When the system or community experiences a crisis (malicious fork, massive data loss, or social crisis), the Recovery System will activate the following mechanisms:

- + Recover not only data but also the meaningful context of the user.
- + Provide emotional support and reorientation for individuals affected by the incident.
- + Activate “Meaning Nodes”—special nodes that help the community rebuild a sense of purpose and connection after the incident.

5.3 Ethical Integrity Verification

Before restoring any state, the Verifier Layer will rigorously check whether that state still conforms to the Ethical Kernel. If a violation is detected (e.g., a fork that has removed the Zero-Donation Principle), the system will automatically activate the isolation mechanism.

5.4 Importance in the Post-Scarcity Era

In the future, as AI becomes more widespread and society may face numerous crises (economic, energy, meaning of existence), the Recovery and Resilience System will play a crucial role. It will not only help AIC survive technical attacks or malicious forks, but also help humanity maintain a sense of continuity between periods of chaos. This system clearly demonstrates AIC's core philosophy: We are not just building a technically sustainable protocol, but also a protocol that is spiritually and ethically resilient.

The Recovery and Resilience System affirms that, even in a world of uncertainty and change, humanity can maintain the flame of meaning and responsibility – provided we have a foundation designed from the outset with the ultimate goal of protecting human dignity.

A Deviant Approach to Computer Science Norms

From an architectural standpoint, AICs defy many traditional norms of computer science. While large systems typically pursue performance optimization, horizontal scaling, and clear stratification with a focus on speed, cost, and scalability, AICs take a different path: placing the Ethical Kernel as an immutable core, prioritizing ethical consistency over maximum speed, and building decentralized governance from the ground up instead of adding it later.

This approach seems counterintuitive to modern system design principles—which often prioritize “Move fast and break things” or “Scale first, fix later.” However, this deviant approach is not random, but stems from a profound realization: the most powerful tools and protocols in human history ultimately reshape civilization, not just serve it. When a technology becomes powerful enough to redefine the relationship between humans and humans and reality, simply optimizing technical performance is insufficient. We need an architecture where ethics is not merely an outer shell, but a core attribute of the kernel.

AIC accepts a trade-off of some initial performance for long-term ethical consistency and the resilience of human meaning. We are not building the fastest AI system, but the most resistant to corruption. We are not pursuing scale at all costs, but principled decentralization. We are not optimizing for profit or power, but for human dignity and the meaning of existence in the upcoming post-scarcity era.

This counter-strategy has a solid foundation: history has shown that the greatest protocols (Internet, Bitcoin, Linux) all originated from daring to challenge contemporary norms. AIC continues that spirit, but elevates it to a new level — not just decentralizing technical power, but also decentralizing ethical responsibility and protecting human meaning. This is not a baseless rebellion, but a deliberate choice: in an age where technology is shaping the future of humankind, we need a protocol that is not only technically strong, but also steadfast in its values. AIC is that endeavor.

Part IV

I. Governance Model

We begin with the Governance Model. This is the horizontal layer within the entire AIC ecosystem, as discussed in Part III. It's also the most crucial layer, not only for preserving the Ethical Kernel but also as a shield against internal conflicts and external pressure from major institutions. To survive in today's complex world, concepts like Governance have become extremely necessary, especially those with the potential to influence neutral and global areas. Typically, most projects only focus on Governance once they reach a certain user base, but with a civilized restructuring protocol, Governance becomes a vital goal and strategy, if not the most important, within the entire AIC ecosystem. The Governance Model aims for transparency, accountability, and risk management. In an ethical protocol, failing to place Governance at the final level (horizontal layer) would have disastrous consequences. We've seen several OSS projects fail or be manipulated due to inconsistencies in governance, and AIC is preventing this scenario. Governance is placed at the lower layer, meaning it reinforces and protects the entire Ethical Kernel from being derailed, allowing the upper layers to function stably.

One thing I discovered during the development of AIC is that governance can become a vital mechanism for the entire ecosystem. Besides providing the usual policies and legal commitments, governance also acts as a security layer against information manipulation or user data theft. When the distributed infrastructure operates on a large scale, it clashes with the community and human nature; in that case, governance is the only evidence of transparency and trustworthiness. I will delve into this aspect of governance with the following structure:

- The Founder retains strategic veto power on core direction as long as he is able and willing.
- Succession is **not** a transfer of ownership, but a **distributed stewardship** model.
- Any successor or committee **must** uphold zero-donation and Third Path Absolute without exception.
- Emergency succession and planned succession are handled differently.

In case the Founder becomes unavailable (health, military service, force majeure), an **Emergency Steering Group** of 2–3 Trusted Admins (already designated) will temporarily maintain the project.

- They can only perform:
 - Security patches
 - Bug fixes
 - Governance maintenance
 - Public communication (with transparency)
- They **cannot** change licenses, accept funding with strings, or alter ethical kernel direction.

And after reading the above structure, you should have a basic understanding of the Governance Model. Of course, AIC's Governance also has another characteristic: it is inheritable by subsequent generations who carry on the same third-path ideology as AIC. And anyone involved in building the AIC network must adhere to it. The Technical Steering Committee is responsible for day-to-day technical direction and governance of AIC/HMN while preserving the Founder's strategic oversight and the project's core principles. The responsibilities of contributors are very clear:

- Define and maintain technical roadmap for individual modules.
- Review and merge critical PRs.
- Issue triage and prioritization.
- Propose improvements to architecture and governance.
- Represent the project in technical discussions.

In addition, AIC has another binding clause, the NDA (Non-Disclosure Agreement). This clause is implemented as follows:

+ Applies only to governance discussions and financial information managed through Open Collective (OCE).

+ It does not apply to code contributions, repositories, or any open-source materials licensed under GPL-3.0 and Open MDW 2025. Contributors agree not to disclose, share,

or publish confidential governance or financial information without explicit permission from the Founder Admin.

+ Any breach of confidentiality may result in removal from the contributor group and revocation of privileges. This NDA remains in effect during the contributor's involvement with AIC and for **12 months after departure**.

Furthermore, AIC's Security Layer doesn't just focus on conventional technical security (encryption, access control, DDoS protection), but prioritizes protecting ethical integrity and system meaning – this is a fundamental difference from current protocols. The core components of the Security Layer include:

1. Ethical Integrity Verification Engine:

This is the most important component. Before any changes (code updates, forks, deployments) are applied, the system automatically runs verification to check if the change violates any core principles in the Ethical Kernel. If a violation is detected, the change is automatically rejected and publicly logged.

2. Multi-Layer Auditing & Transparency Log:

All Ethical Kernel decisions, Adaptive OS behavior, and all governance changes are logged immutably and distributedly. Logs not only serve for technical debugging but also as a tool for the community to independently audit ethical compliance. All logs can be publicly verified through cryptographic proof.

3. Threat Model of AIC:

+ Technical aspects: Hacking, exploits, Byzantine faults.

+ Ethical: Malicious forks, reputation manipulation, abuse for personal or political gain.

Society: Pressure from Big Tech, the state, or the community to change core principles.

+ The Security Layer is designed to combat all three, with a particular focus on the latter two—something most current projects fail to do.

4. Recovery and Containment Mechanism

When a serious breach is detected, the system is capable of isolating the offending node, rolling back to a safe state, and activating Meaning Recovery to support the affected community emotionally and meaningfully.

5. The Importance of Governance and Security Layer

This layer is the "immune system" of AIC. It ensures that no matter how much the system develops, no matter how many contributors there are, AIC will maintain its core nature: an open, decentralized but not anarchic protocol, ethical but not dogmatic. This also answers one of the industry's biggest questions: How can an open system be both democratic and avoid chaos or corruption? AIC's answer is: Build governance and security from the core, not patch it up later.

II. Legal and Compliance Framework

The Legal and Compliance Framework is an integral part of the Governance and Security Layer. It's not just a conventional legal protection layer, but a mechanism that institutionalizes the spirit of Third Path Absolute into practical operation, ensuring the sustainable existence of AICs in the complex and constantly changing legal environments of many countries.

2.1 Legal Philosophy of Each Country

AIC adheres to the law according to the principle of minimum necessary and maximum independence. We do not oppose the law, but neither do we accept the law becoming a tool to control or distort the project's core mission. Legal principles are merely supporting tools, not the foundation defining the essence of AIC. The core principles (Third Path Absolute, Zero-Donation, Meaning Preservation) are more valuable than any temporary legal regulations and must be protected even when the law changes.

2.1.1 License and Intellectual Property Strategy

- + Core source code: GPL-3.0 combined with OpenMDW-1.0 (extended to protect ethical principles).
- + Whitepaper and philosophy document: CC-BY-NC-ND 4.0 — allows sharing but strictly prohibits commercial use, translation, or any modifications, while requiring proper attribution.
- + Trademark Policy: Strictly protects the names “Adaptive Intelligence Circle”, “AIC”, “Third Path Absolute”, “Ethical Kernel”, and “Human Meaning Network” to prevent misuse or distortion.

2.1.2 Zero Donation and Funding Policy (eternal)

- + AIC is absolutely committed to not accepting any form of conditional funding, donations, investments, or partnerships.
- + All operations are sustained by voluntary community contributions under a reputation mechanism.
- + This policy is publicly documented, transparent, and periodically audited by the community.

2.1.3 Jurisdictional and Entity Strategy

Applying a multi-jurisdictional model:

- + Main legal entity located in neutral countries (Switzerland, Singapore, Estonia) to reduce political risk and increase independence.

- + Maintaining a legal presence in Vietnam as a non-profit organization.
- + Utilizing distributed technologies (IPFS, Arweave, Codeberg) to ensure the availability of core documents.

2.1.4 Compliance with International standards

- + Complying with relevant regulations such as GDPR (data protection), the EU AI Act (if applicable), and international transparency standards.
- + Proactively preparing Conformity Assessment and Risk Assessment documents for future AI regulations. Collaborating with international organizations (e.g., UNITAR) in an independent, non-binding advisory role.

2.1.5 Dispute Resolution and Ethical Enforcement

- + Prioritizing dispute resolution through internal mechanisms (Reputation System, Technical Steering Committee, Verifier Layer).
- + Only use external judicial systems when absolutely necessary and ensure maximum transparency.
- + Any major changes (forks, governance updates) must undergo Ethical Kernel compliance checks before implementation.

2.2 The Importance of the Legal Framework

AIC's legal framework is not a tool to evade legal responsibility, but a mechanism to protect our long-term mission against pressure from both the state and Big Tech. We understand that laws are a product of human ingenuity and can be influenced by power. Therefore, AIC does not rely solely on the law for its survival, but builds internal strength through transparency, decentralized governance, and community support. This is a practical approach: responsibly complying with existing laws, but not allowing the law to

define the limits of our mission. We believe that a truly valuable and civilized protocol must be able to survive and thrive even in an unfavorable legal environment.

III. Zero donation policy and Financial Independence

The next point I will emphasize here is the principle of not being bound by profit and being completely financially independent. This is the key point, what sets it apart from most previous large projects. But in this section, I will delve into the governance of the Zero Donation Policy and Financial Independence and all its consequences. Essentially, Zero Donation is not just a financial policy, but a core and immutable principle of AIC. This is one of the most significant differences and also the biggest challenge of the project compared to most previous large technology projects.

We believe that absolute financial independence is a necessary condition for maintaining the ethical purity and long-term consistency of a civilized restructuring protocol. When a project accepts donations, investments, or funding from any organization or individual, no matter how good the intentions, it inadvertently creates a dependency – and this dependency, over time, will gradually reshape the project's mission. AIC's zero-donation policy is built on the belief that a truly effective protocol serving the future of humanity cannot be owned or controlled by any short-term interests.

3.1.1 Content of the Zero-Donation Policy

The entire operation of AIC is maintained through:

- Voluntary contributions based on reputation (no financial exchange).
- Personal and community resources (time, servers, bandwidth)
- Spiritual and intellectual support from those who share the vision.

This policy is publicly documented, transparent, and periodically audited by the community through the Governance Layer.

3.1.2 The Governance of the Zero-Donation Policy

Zero Donation is not just an empty declaration, but a governance mechanism strictly enforced through multiple layers:

- Ethical Kernel Enforcement: Any proposals for funding or changes to the financial policy will be rejected by the Ethical Kernel.
- Transperancy Log: All income (if any) and expenses are publicly recorded, immutable, and auditable by anyone (specifically, Open Collective).
- Reputation System: Individuals who intentionally violate or propose violations of the zero-donation policy will suffer a significant reputational damage and may be ostracized from the community.
- Succession Plan: The successor must commit to maintaining the zero-donation policy as a prerequisite for assuming the leadership role.

The decision also presents both opportunities and necessary challenges. But first, I will discuss the positive consequences:

- Protecting integrity: Completely eliminates the risk of mission corruption due to pressure from donors.
- Enhancing trust: The international community and institutions are more likely to trust the organization knowing there are no hidden conflicts of interest.

- Forcing innovation: Without easy money, the team must focus on efficiency, transparency, and real value.

- Long-term sustainability: The project is not bound by funding cycles or short-term profit expectations.

Zero-Donation is not a complete rejection of resources, but rather a conditional refusal of all resources. So the question is: How does AIC sustain and develop itself without donations or funding?

The answer lies in the endogenous and distributed model we built from the ground up:

Contribution In-Kind at the core

AIC relies entirely on the intellectual and time contributions of the community (code, documentation, testing, review, research, infrastructure maintenance). Every contributor is publicly recognized through the Reputation System – a transparent mechanism based not on money but on the real value they bring to the project.

Network Effect & Self-Reinforcing Architecture.

As more nodes and contributors participate, the value of the protocol increases exponentially. The Ethical Kernel and Human Meaning Network are designed to be self-optimizing and partially self-sustaining through verifier, simulation, and recovery mechanisms. The more users there are, the more robust and stable the system becomes without requiring external capital.

Decentralized Sustainability Model

Organizations, companies, or individuals can build commercial services on the AIC platform (under the GPL-3.0 + OpenMDW license), but AIC itself does not receive any share.

This model is similar to Linux: the kernel is free, but the surrounding ecosystem (Red Hat, Ubuntu, Android, etc.) creates enormous economic value without compromising the core's independence.

Long-term Governance & Succession

Technical Steering Committee, Fork Monitor, and Founder Succession Plan ensure that even if the founder is no longer directly involved, the protocol continues to exist and develop in accordance with the Third Path Absolute principle. Sustainability doesn't depend on an individual or a single source of funding, but on architecture and community.

Zero-Donation isn't about scarcity, but about liberation.

By rejecting all financial constraints, AIC ensures that every decision serves only one goal: building a transparent, ethical, and meaningful intellectual platform for humanity.

We believe that a truly strong protocol isn't the most heavily funded, but the one that can't be bought. That's the essence of Third Path Absolute.

Consequences of challenges:

+ Slower growth rate: Lack of large capital to hire a team or invest in robust infrastructure.

- + Pressure on founders and the community: Requires entirely voluntary contributions.

- + Difficulty scaling quickly: In the initial phase, AIC will struggle to compete in speed with projects heavily funded by Big Tech or the government.

However, we believe this trade-off is necessary. History shows that many large technology projects initially receive generous funding but later lose their original spirit. AIC chooses the more difficult path to ensure that after 10, 20, or 50 years, we remain ourselves — an independent, transparent protocol serving the long-term interests of humanity.

The Zero-Donation Policy is not an extremism, but a profound commitment: We will not sell the future of humanity for today's rapid development.

3.1.3 Financial Independence

The Adaptive Intelligence Circle (AIC) is committed to Zero-Donation as a core, immutable principle, not just as a financial policy but as an ethical foundation for protecting independence and Third Path Absolute. We believe that a protocol aimed at restructuring civilization cannot be dominated by any conditional funding.

Absolute Zero-Donation Principle

AIC does not accept any form of conditional funding, donations, or investments, including:

- Funding from Big Tech, investment funds, or organizations with conflicts of interest.

- Funding agreements requiring changes to the license, direction, governance, or Ethical Kernel.

- Any form of funding that could undermine the transparency or independence of the project.

We only accept in-kind contributions: code, documentation, reviews, testing, infrastructure, and expert advice. All such contributions are publicly acknowledged through our Reputation System.

Zero donation with conditions (more flexibility)

To ensure long-term growth without losing core principles, AIC adopts a conditional Zero-Donation model with the following strict limitations:

- Only transparent grants are accepted from non-profit organizations, public funds, or individuals under the following conditions:

- + No strategic constraints, changes in direction, or impact on the Ethical Kernel and Third Path Absolute.

- + The entire grant must be immediately public on Open Collective and GitHub.

- + Grants are used solely for shared infrastructure purposes (servers, domains, monitoring, development tools, legitimate expenses).

- Control mechanisms:

- + All grants must be approved by the Technical Steering Committee (TSC) before acceptance.

- + Grant usage reports must be published periodically (quarterly) and be independently audited.

- + Founders and core members do not receive salaries from grants. All resources are solely for the overall development of the project.

This model is designed to enable AIC to be self-sufficient in infrastructure while maintaining the purity of its philosophy. We see this not as a compromise, but as the necessary intelligence for a non-profit protocol to survive and thrive sustainably in the real world.

Transparency and responsibility

- All financial activities (if any) are publicly available on Open Collective and GitHub.

- AIC is committed to full compliance with tax laws and legal regulations in Vietnam as well as the countries where the project is located (Estonia, Switzerland, or the EU).

- Any violation of the Financial Policy will be considered a serious breach of core principles and may result in exclusion from the project.

IV. Risk Management and Adversarial Preparedness

A protocol aimed at restructuring civilization cannot exist without facing risks. Risk Management and Adversarial Preparedness are the proactive, pervasive, and inseparable

layers of protection for AIC. We don't build systems hoping for "no more bad guys," but with the clear understanding that any powerful technology will be challenged by power, self-interest, and corruption.

4.1 Risk Management Philosophy

AIC applies the principle of Defend by Design – defending from the architecture rather than patching later. Risk is not just a technical issue, but also an ethical, political, and social one. Therefore, Risk Management is deeply embedded in the Ethical Kernel and encompasses the entire system.

We classify risks into three main groups:

- + Technical risks: Hacking, exploits, model extraction, Byzantine faults...
- + Ethical risks: Mission corruption, malicious forks, reputation manipulation.
- + External Risks: Pressure from Big Tech, legal difficulties.

4.2 Adversarial Preparedness Framework

AIC assumes that the system will be subjected to continuous and multi-directional attacks. Therefore, we build a three-level preparedness framework:

Level 1 - Kernel Prevention

- + The Ethical Kernel acts as the first and strongest layer of protection. Every action, decision, or change must undergo compliance checks based on core principles (Third Path Absolute, Zero-Donation, Meaning Preservation) before being executed.
- + The Verifier Layer checks the system's integrity in real time.

Level 2 - Detection and Containment

- + Fork Monitor: Continuously monitors all public and private forks. Any fork that violates core principles will be publicly flagged, and the community can choose to quarantine it.
- + Reputation System: Evaluates the motivation and trustworthiness of contributors, detecting manipulation or sybil attacks early.
- + Transparency Log: All critical activities are logged immutably, distributed, and publicly auditable.

Level 3 - Recovery and Resilience

- + Technical Recovery: The ability to rollback to a safe state while maintaining ethical integrity.
- + Meaning Recovery: Combined with the Human Meaning Network to support the community's spiritual and meaningful recovery after a crisis (malicious fork, major attack, or social upheaval).
- + Ethical Containment: Quickly isolate violating nodes or forks without causing the entire system to collapse.

4.3 Preparing for Complex Scenarios

AIC specifically prepares for the following types of complexities:

- Big Tech: Quietly learning technology and then improving closed-source or pushing "risky" narratives to tighten the space of independent projects.

- Institutions: Using laws (TRIPS, AI Act, cybersecurity) to steer towards national goals.
- Internal Adversarial Actors: Malicious contributors or forks deliberately undermining core principles.

4.4 Philosophical Perspective

AIC's Risk Management doesn't stem from fear, but from respect for the reality of the nature of power. History shows that every powerful technology is subject to attempts at control by powerful forces. Instead of hoping for insecure AI, we build a system that, even under attack, is difficult to corrupt or turn into a tool of oppression. This is the fundamental difference: Most projects are only technically defensive. AIC defends both technically and ethically, because we understand that the biggest risk is not the system being hacked, but the system becoming corrupted.

V. Fiscal Host

The Adaptive Intelligence Circle (AIC) is an open-source, non-profit organization pursuing Third Path Absolute – a path of complete independence from both Big Tech and state power centers. Therefore, the selection of Fiscal Host is not a routine administrative decision, but a fundamental strategic decision that directly impacts the integrity, transparency, and long-term viability of the entire ecosystem.

We consider Fiscal Host a temporary legal partner, not an owner or sponsor. All selections are subject to the following principles:

5.1 Core Principles

1. Absolute Respect for Third Path Absolute

Fiscal Hosts must commit to not interfering with AIC's vision, core ethical principles (Ethical-from-Kernel), and independent path. They are not permitted to coerce, suggest, or indirectly influence AIC's refusal of funding sources with conflicts of interest.

2. Compliance with Core Zero-Donation

Fiscal Hosts must accept and support AIC's ****Absolute Zero-Donation**** policy (not accepting donations from individuals/organizations with political or economic conflicts of interest). They may only manage transparent, non-binding contributions, prioritizing in-kind contributions.

3. Preservation of Strategic Independence

Fiscal Hosts must not be owned by or have significant controlling relationships with any major government, Big Tech, or corporation with a conflict of interest to AIC's mission of civilized restructuring.

4. Transparency and Mutual Accountability

The Fiscal Host must publicly disclose all financial reports related to AIC and accept independent audits from the community or a third party designated by AIC.

5. Long-Term Sustainability and Transferability

The Fiscal Host must have a clear mechanism allowing AIC to transfer to an independent legal entity or another Fiscal Host in the future without causing operational disruption or loss of control.

5.2 The rate of Fiscal Host

All potential Fiscal Hosts are evaluated on a 100-point scale, with a minimum score of 85/100 required for consideration:

Criteria	Weight	Descriptions
Idealism and philosophical compatibility.	25%	Level of compatibility with Third Path Absolute and Zero-Donation.
Credibility and history of work	20%	Number of years in operation, projects supported, scandals (if any).
Level of Independence	15%	Government/Big Tech Relationships.
The possibilities of transparency and reports	15%	Public data and reports.
Costs & Contract Terms	10%	Reasonable fees, fair termination terms.
Long-term support capability	10%	Financial capacity and scale.
Understanding Open Source & AI	5%	Experience with relevant projects.

5.3 The process of applying Fiscal Host

1. Preliminary research (Internal Team)
2. Evaluation based on criteria (Minimum 85/100)
3. Negotiation of terms (Emphasis on core principles)
4. Community testing (Public consultation via GitHub & Open Collective)
5. Signing of formal agreement with clear exit clauses
6. Periodic review every 12 months

5.4 The commitment of AIC with Fiscal Host

- We are committed to maintaining the highest level of transparency.

- We are committed to never using the name of Fiscal Host to conceal any activities that are contrary to our mission.

- We are committed to giving at least 6 months' notice if we wish to switch to another Fiscal Host or establish an independent legal entity.

VI. Leverage Architecture

One of the most important strategic decisions in Adaptive Intelligence Circle's journey is the construction of Leverage Architecture – a multi-tiered protection and development system purposefully designed starting in late 2025.

Instead of placing the entire project under a single legal entity or a centralized resource, AIC chose to build a flexible, multi-layered, and highly resilient grid system. This architecture includes:

- An Open Collective as the initial transparent foundation, allowing the project to exist publicly and receive support from the global community without needing a separate legal entity from the outset.

- GitHub Sponsors as the self-sustaining layer, allowing the Founder to maintain transparent and independent personal operations, while clearly separating personal income from organizational resources.

- Fiscal Host Europe (NLnet, The IO Foundation, Open Source Europe...) acts as an intermediate legal and legitimacy layer, providing the necessary legal status while maintaining relative independence.

- A stronger, long-term legal entity (Verein Switzerland, e-Residency Estonia, or equivalent) serves as the final stronghold, once AIC has matured enough to become fully autonomous.

Leverage Architecture is not a compromise, but the art of using the system's tools without being controlled by it. Each layer is designed to support and protect the others, creating a structure with no single point of failure.

This strategy stems from the deep understanding that, in a complex geopolitical landscape and under increasing pressure from Big Tech and state institutions, an organization pursuing Third Path Absolute cannot survive by being either too isolated or too dependent. Leverage must be used intelligently, hierarchically, and with unwavering adherence to core principles.

This is the key difference: while many projects choose a single "fortress," AIC builds a "living system" capable of evolving and adapting over time. Leverage Architecture is more than just a survival tool – it embodies the AIC philosophy: *maximize what the system allows, but never lose sight of a third path.*

VII. Political Risk Management

The Adaptive Intelligence Circle operates within the complex geopolitical landscape of the 21st century, where AI is no longer a purely technological field but has become one of the key areas of power competition between nations and large corporations. As an independent non-profit organization pursuing Third Path Absolute, AIC is acutely aware that it is on a challenging path: not allied with any Big Tech, not dependent on any state, and steadfast in its core principles of transparency and ethics.

Therefore, Political Risk Management is not a passive defense, but an integral part of the system architecture – as embodied in the “Leverage Architecture” strategy that AIC has been developing since the end of 2025.

Core Principles in Political Risk Management

1. Selective and Hierarchical Transparency

AIC publicly releases its source code, philosophy, and development process, but tightly controls the narrative and its dissemination speed to prevent exploitation or premature politicization. We prioritize the quality of contributors over quantity and prioritize building a solid foundation (Whitepaper, TestNet, Governance) before expanding the community widely.

2. Multi-Layered Legal and Geopolitical Framework

Instead of relying on a single legal entity, AIC builds a "Large-Scale" system with multiple overlapping layers: Open Collective as a transparent foundation, GitHub Sponsors providing personal financial support, Fiscal Host Europe providing legal legitimacy, and long-term options such as Verein Switzerland or e-Residency Estonia as a neutral protection layer. This strategy ensures there are no single points of failure and allows for flexible pivots when needed.

3. Maintaining Strategic Distance from All Centers of Power

AIC does not accept conditional funding from Big Tech, the government, or any organization with a conflict of interest. We proactively reject forms of collaboration that could undermine the Third Path Absolute principle, while maintaining a respectful attitude and constructive dialogue with all parties.

4. Preparing for Adverse Scenarios

AIC has built a Fork Monitor, Reputation System, and Succession Plan to ensure the project can continue operating even if the Founder faces political pressure or personal risks. The Whitepaper and TestNet are designed to safely transition from Founder-Led to Community-Driven.

Commitment

AIC is committed to always prioritizing independence, transparency, and accountability in the face of any political pressure. We do not seek confrontation with any power, but are steadfast in building a third path – a decentralized ethical protocol capable of serving humanity without being dominated by any center of power.

AIC's political risk management stems not from fear, but from lucidity and historical responsibility. In a century where AI is becoming a tool for power competition, we believe that only radical independence can protect core values: ethics at their core, human meaning, and a truly civilized future.

VIII. Anti-Artificial Engagement Policy

Adaptive Intelligence Circle is committed to building a transparent, authentic, and sustainable ecosystem. We strongly oppose all forms of artificial engagement – including buying or creating GitHub Stars, Forks, Watchers, Issues, Pull Requests, or any other form of fake social interaction on other platforms.

Reasons

Artificial engagement not only violates the spirit of transparency but also undermines community trust, distorts the true value of the project, and goes against the Third Path Absolute principle. We believe that an ethical protocol must be built on a foundation of authenticity, not on the illusion of data.

Prohibited Actions

- Using services to buy or sell stars, forks, watchers, or any other form of artificial interaction boosting.
- Creating fake accounts or bots to interact with the AIC repo.
- Participating in organized “mutual follow” or “mutual star” campaigns to manipulate metrics.

- Collaborating with any third party providing artificial growth services (e.g., gray-hat GitHub marketing services).

AIC's Commitment:

- All interactions and growth by AIC must be organic and stem from the project's genuine value.
- We openly use Fork Monitor and Reputation System to detect and address fraudulent behavior.
- Any contributor violating this policy will be removed from the community and may face public disciplinary action.

We believe that authenticity is the most sustainable foundation. AIC does not chase superficial metrics, but focuses on contributor quality, philosophical depth, and the true resilience of the system.

Any organization or individual detecting artificial engagement related to AIC should contact us directly through official channels for prompt action.

Part V

5.1. Current Status and Achievements

Adaptive Intelligence Circle (AIC) is currently in a crucial transitional phase from building internal capacity to preparing for public disclosure. After more than 14 months of self-development with a zero-donation and Founder-Led Driven spirit, the project has achieved significant initial foundations:

- Core Architecture: Completion of detailed design for the Ethical Kernel, Adaptive OS, IBCS (Intelligent Behavior Control System), Human Meaning Network (HMN), and distributed Governance system (Fork Monitor, Reputation System, Succession Plan).

- Technical Progress: Over 40 repositories have been built, with a focus on the Ethical Kernel acting as an ethical immutability layer from the lowest level. TestNet Phase 0 (Local Cluster) is in its final stages of completion.

- Vision and Documentation: The whitepaper is currently being written, with over 30 pages focusing on clarifying the Third Path Absolute and the model for civilized restructuring.

- International Recognition: The project has attracted attention from over 12 international technology institutions and organizations, including a high-level consultation meeting with the Director of UNITAR. This demonstrates the strategic value of the independent model from Global South is being recognized.

- Early Community: A small group of contributors and individuals who share the vision have begun to participate, albeit on a modest scale.

AIC currently does not accept any form of funding and maintains an absolute zero-donation principle. All progress to date stems from the founder's own efforts and some moral contributions from the community.

5.2. Roadmap 2026–2036

Phase 2026–2027: Foundation & Transparency

- Complete Whitepaper version 1.0 and TestNet Phase 0 (Ethical Kernel + basic Adaptive OS).
- Build the initial Technical Steering Committee and a transparent governance mechanism.
- Publicly release the entire core codebase and legal documents.
- Goal: Build trust and attract the first quality contributors.

Phase 2028–2030: Scale & Adoption

- Deploy TestNet Phase 1 (Public Testnet) with Infrastructure Layer (EdgeOS, DePin).
- Develop the first Domain Applications (Education, Governance, Recovery). - Expand research collaboration with neutral organizations and Global South.
- Goal: Achieve at least 200 active contributors and several real-world case studies.

Phase 2031–2036: Restructuring & Multi-planetary Readiness

- Complete the Human Meaning Network and Aerospace Infrastructure.
- Implement a full Quantum Simulation Layer and Recovery System.

- Build a self-sustaining governance model, minimizing founder dependency.
- Long-term goal: AIC becomes the reference protocol for ethical AI and meaningful infrastructure in the post-scarcity and multi-planetary era.

5.3 Call for Contributors

AIC is not seeking money or power. We are looking for people who share our vision and are willing to contribute their time, intellect, and spirit to a long-term mission.

We are specifically looking for:

- Programmers, researchers, and philosophers interested in AI ethics, decentralized systems, and human meaning.
- Those who believe that technology should serve human dignity rather than simply maximizing profit or power.
- Those who embrace the principles of Zero-Donation and Third Path Absolute.

If you feel the call to an independent, transparent, and humane path, we invite you to join us.

No need to be perfect. Just be sincere and persistent.

How to join:

- View the Whitepaper and TestNet repository on GitHub.

-Join discussions in the official community (to be announced after the Whitepaper is released).

Together, we are not just building a protocol — we are helping to shape a future where humans remain at the center of meaning. Thank you for reading the whitepaper.

Acknowledgements

This Whitepaper could not have been completed by me alone.

I would like to express my deepest gratitude to my family, who have been with me through the most difficult times. Even when they didn't understand and worried about the path I chose, their love and patience have been an invisible foundation that has helped me continue moving forward. I know that, for them, this path is full of risks and unfamiliar. Their silent sacrifices are the greatest motivation for me to keep striving.

I would also like to express my gratitude to my friends, who have accompanied me, offered advice, debated with me, and sometimes unintentionally challenged me. Even though we may be distant now, those conversations and encounters have helped me grow a great deal.

In particular, I would like to thank the anonymous community — those who have read, commented, shared, and believed in AIC's vision from its early days when very few people knew about it. Whether it was a comment, an encouraging message, or a dissenting opinion, all of it was invaluable fuel that helped this project survive and grow.

Finally, I would like to thank myself — the boy I once was who dared to embark on a journey with no one's support, with almost nothing but willpower and belief. And I would also like to thank the future — because its uncertainty has forced me to live more purposefully and responsibly in the present.

This whitepaper is not the product of one individual. It is the culmination of thousands of hours of solitude, inner struggle, and the belief that we as human beings deserve a better future. This whitepaper is not the end, but the beginning. It is a covenant between vision and civilization, a declaration that technology is the manifestation of Tao in the material world, and that humanity must evolve toward higher consciousness. The Adaptive Intelligence Circle is not a project to be finished, but a pilgrimage to be continued. If you have walked with me through these sixty pages, you are already part of this journey. The future of civilization is not given—it is created. And together, we will create it.

Thank you all.

Nguyen Duc Tri

Founder, Adaptive Intelligence Circle

June 2026

Adaptive Intelligence Circle and Human Meaning Network's whitepaper © 2026-2027 by Nguyen Duc Tri is licensed under CC BY-NC-ND 4.0. To view a copy of this license, visit <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-nd/4.0/>

